

# WEAVE 2027

Wider European Academic Vision for  
Excellence and Transformation

*Weaving Multiple Transformations through  
European University Collaboration*



## Internal Conference Concept

A STARS EU Alliance International Conference

Hosted by Hochschule Bremen (HSB), Germany

Faculty of Business Studies, STARS EU TIG Entrepreneurship and Innovation

Conference Co-Chairs: Stefan Veith and Stephan Form

Dates: 21 and 22 April 2027

Where disciplines meet. Where institutions connect. Where transformation begins.

## Conference Concept

### Vision

Europe is undergoing multiple, simultaneous transformations: ecological, digital, social, cultural, and institutional. No single discipline, no single institution, and no single perspective can address this complexity alone. What is needed is the ability to weave together diverse threads of knowledge, practice, and collaboration into a coherent and purposeful whole. Universities are uniquely positioned to take on this role. As places of research, teaching, and civic engagement, they bring together disciplines, generations, and communities. As members of collaborative alliances such as STARS EU, they can act collectively across borders, pooling expertise, sharing methodologies, and amplifying impact.

**WEAVE 2027** brings together researchers and educators from across Europe to explore a central question:

*How can the multiple transformations Europe is undergoing, ecological, digital, social, cultural, and institutional, be woven together into coherent pathways for a sustainable, inclusive, and dynamic future?*

Universities, working through alliances such as STARS EU, are well placed to host and inform this debate, but the conference focuses on the substance of transformation across sectors and disciplines, not on higher education as such.

### Mission

WEAVE 2027 places **European collaboration, interdisciplinary research, and transformative education** at the heart of the debate. Hosted by the STARS EU TIG **Entrepreneurship and Innovation** at Hochschule Bremen, the conference is open to contributions from all nine STARS EU TIGs and from researchers outside the Alliance.

The conference is guided by a core belief: **transformation is not linear, not singular, and not achieved alone**. It requires the weaving of many strands, of knowledge and practice, tradition and innovation, local rootedness and European vision.

### The STARS EU Thematic Interest Groups

The STARS EU Alliance is organised around nine Thematic Interest Groups. WEAVE 2027 invites contributions from all nine on an equal footing. The host TIG at Hochschule Bremen is Entrepreneurship and Innovation, but no thematic strand is pre-prioritised in the call. The Scientific Committee allocates accepted papers to thematic sessions after review, drawing on the natural connections between the TIGs.

| TIG                                    | Transformation Strand                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Entrepreneurship and Innovation</b> | Economic transformation, innovation ecosystems, start-up cultures, entrepreneurial pedagogy.              |
| <b>Sustainable Industry</b>            | Industrial transformation, circular production, responsible manufacturing, applied research partnerships. |
| <b>Digital Transformation</b>          | Technological transformation, digital literacy, data governance, AI in business and society.              |
| <b>Circular Economy</b>                | Resource transformation, systemic design, material intelligence, lifecycle thinking.                      |
| <b>Inclusion and Social Justice</b>    | Social transformation, equity, access, participatory research, ethics of change.                          |
| <b>Energy Transition</b>               | Towards carbon-neutral societies, collaborative research, community engagement.                           |
| <b>Living Spaces</b>                   | Spatial transformation, smart cities, sustainable mobility, place-based learning.                         |
| <b>Healthy Ageing</b>                  | Demographic transformation, assistive innovation, ageing-inclusive design.                                |
| <b>Art and creative industries</b>     | Cultural transformation, creativity, identity, the evolving role of arts in European societies.           |

## The WEAVE Metaphor

The image of weaving is central to the conference identity. Just as a woven fabric draws strength and beauty from the interlocking of many individual threads, **WEAVE 2027** draws its power from the connections between:

- **Disciplines**, including natural sciences, social sciences, humanities, arts, and engineering.
- **Institutions**, the nine partner universities, each bringing distinct strengths and perspectives.
- **Transformation pathways**, the nine TIGs, each addressing a different dimension of European change.
- **Actors**, including researchers, educators, and students.

The result is not a patchwork but a **fabric**: coherent, resilient, and greater than the sum of its parts.

## Format and Structure

WEAVE 2027 is designed as a **1.5-day international conference** for up to 60 participants, hosted in two parallel rooms at Hochschule Bremen on **Wednesday 21 and Thursday 22 April 2027**, with an opening Networking Dinner on Tuesday 20 April. Each 90-minute session slot hosts three papers, each presented in 15 to 18 minutes, followed by a 7 to 8 minute Discussant statement and 4 to 5 minutes of audience Q&A. Each accepted paper is assigned one Discussant, drawn reciprocally from the pool of accepted authors.

### Tuesday evening, 20 April 2027, Welcome and Networking

- 18:00 Welcome Reception at HSB.
- 19:00 Networking Dinner.

### Wednesday, 21 April 2027, full day, Laying the Threads

- 08:30 to 09:00 Registration and morning coffee.
- 09:00 to 09:30 Opening Ceremony, welcome from HSB and STARS EU.
- 09:30 to 10:30 Keynote 1, Multiple Transformation and the European University.
- 10:30 to 11:00 Coffee break.
- 11:00 to 12:30 Parallel Sessions A1 and B1.
- 12:30 to 13:30 Lunch.
- 13:30 to 15:00 Parallel Sessions A2 and B2.
- 15:00 to 15:30 Coffee break.
- 15:30 to 17:00 Parallel Sessions A3 and B3.
- 17:00 to 18:30 Cross-TIG Open Space.
- 19:00 Conference Dinner.

### Thursday, 22 April 2027, half day, Weaving the Fabric

- 09:00 to 10:30 Parallel Sessions A4 and B4.
- 10:30 to 11:00 Coffee break.
- 11:00 to 12:00 Keynote 2, Collaboration as a Transformative Force.
- 12:00 to 12:30 Closing Plenary and WEAVE Declaration.
- 12:30 to 13:30 Farewell Lunch.

This baseline accommodates up to 24 papers on Day 1 and 6 papers on Day 2, for a total of 30 paper slots. If submission volume warrants, a third parallel room can be added, raising capacity to 45 slots.

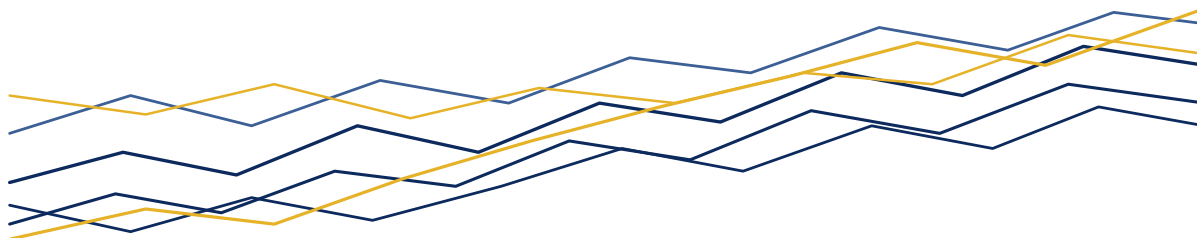
**Cross-TIG Open Space.** The 90-minute block on Wednesday afternoon is kept free of paper presentations. One parallel room runs an open cross-TIG discussion format; the second parallel room is available on request to any STARS EU TIG whose coordinators wish to hold a TIG meeting during the conference. No TIG is pre-assigned the room, the offer goes equally to all nine, and the scientific programme stays clearly dominant.

**Online sessions.** Alongside the on-site programme, WEAVE 2027 runs parallel online-only sessions delivered by video conference. These are not hybrid sessions, each session is either fully on-site or fully online, never mixed. Online sessions follow the same 90-minute format, the same reciprocal Discussant model, and the same review standard as on-site sessions, and are peer-moderated by the participating authors. They add presentation capacity without requiring a third

physical room and allow researchers who cannot travel to take part. The Opening Ceremony, both Keynotes, and the Closing Plenary are streamed so that online participants share the common moments of the conference.

### **Target Audience**

- Researchers and academics from STARS EU partner universities and beyond.
- Teaching staff engaged in interdisciplinary and collaborative education.
- Selected doctoral candidates working across transformation-related fields.



# WEAVE 2027

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for Excellence and Transformation  
*Weaving Multiple Transformations through  
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**Conference:** A STARS EU Alliance International Conference  
**Hosted by:** Hochschule Bremen (HSB), Germany, TIG Entrepreneurship and Innovation  
**Open to:** Researchers, educators and doctoral candidates, both from STARS EU Alliance partners and from institutions beyond the Alliance  
**Dates:** Wednesday 21 and Thursday 22 April 2027, on-site with parallel online sessions  
**Language:** English  
**Co-Chairs:** Stefan Veith and Stephan Form, Hochschule Bremen

## Conference Concept

Europe is undergoing multiple, simultaneous transformations, ecological, digital, social, cultural, and institutional. No single discipline, no single institution, and no single perspective can address this complexity alone. **WEAVE 2027** brings together researchers and educators from across Europe to explore one central question:

*How can the multiple transformations Europe is undergoing be woven together into coherent pathways for a sustainable, inclusive, and dynamic future?*

The image of weaving is central to the conference identity. Just as a woven fabric draws strength from the interlocking of many individual threads, WEAVE 2027 draws its power from the connections between disciplines, sectors, transformation pathways, and actors.

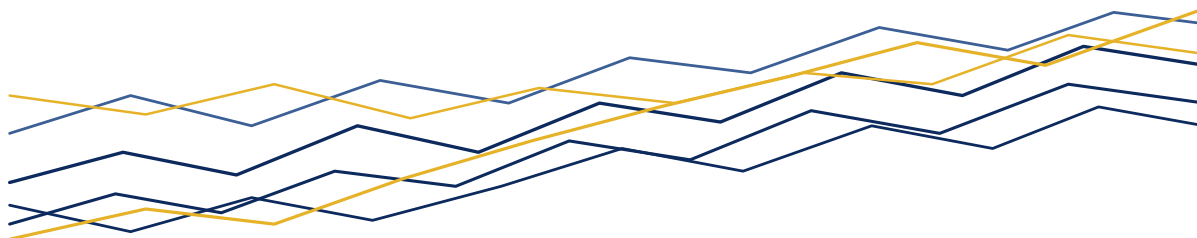
## Thematic Focus

WEAVE 2027 invites contributions from researchers and educators across Europe and beyond, **both from the nine STARS EU Thematic Interest Groups and from institutions outside the Alliance**. The nine TIGs participate on an equal footing: *Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Sustainable Industry, Digital Transformation, Circular Economy, Inclusion and Social Justice, Energy Transition, Living Spaces, Healthy Ageing, and Art and creative industries*. Submissions are not pre-sorted into tracks. The Scientific Committee allocates accepted papers to thematic sessions after review, drawing on the natural connections between the TIGs.

## Submission Format

A single submission format applies, the **Extended Abstract** of 800 to 1500 words, covering research question and motivation, theoretical framing, method, preliminary or expected findings, and contribution to the conference theme. Upon acceptance, authors may optionally upload a **Full Paper** of up to 8000 words for distribution to the assigned Discussant and posting on the conference website. WEAVE 2027 does not publish conference proceedings. Authors are encouraged to submit their work to scientific journals after the conference. All submissions must be in English, and each presenting author may submit at most two Extended Abstracts. Submissions undergo **double-blind peer review** by the WEAVE 2027 Scientific Committee, composed of scholars from European universities active in the thematic fields of the conference.





## Discussant Format

Each accepted paper is assigned a Discussant, drawn reciprocally from the pool of accepted authors. Each 90-minute session hosts three papers, each presented in 15 to 18 minutes, followed by a 7 to 8 minute Discussant statement and 4 to 5 minutes of audience Q&A. Discussants receive the submission three weeks before the conference. This peer-driven format ensures scholarly quality and lively dialogue.

## Participation

WEAVE 2027 is held on-site at Hochschule Bremen and runs parallel online-only sessions for authors who cannot travel. The two modes are not hybrid, each session is either fully on-site or fully online. Online sessions follow the same format, the same Discussant model, and the same double-blind review standard as on-site sessions. Online participation is offered at a reduced conference fee. Authors indicate their preferred mode at submission.

## Key Dates

|                                               |                        |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>Call for Papers opens</b>                  | 1 September 2026       |
| <b>Submission deadline, Extended Abstract</b> | 30 November 2026       |
| <b>Notification of acceptance</b>             | 15 January 2027        |
| <b>Registration opens</b>                     | 20 January 2027        |
| <b>Discussant assignments</b>                 | 15 February 2027       |
| <b>Early bird registration closes</b>         | 15 March 2027          |
| <b>Optional Full Paper upload</b>             | 31 March 2027          |
| <b>Networking Dinner</b>                      | 20 April 2027, evening |
| <b>Conference</b>                             | 21 and 22 April 2027   |

## Contact and Submissions

**Submissions:** via dedicated submission platform, link *TBC*.

**Enquiries:** email *TBC*.

**Website:** [hs-bremen.de/weave](https://hs-bremen.de/weave), *TBC*.



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A STARS EU Alliance Conference



## Internal Appendix

*This section is for internal HSB use and is not part of the public Call for Papers. It captures the conference rationale, partner outreach plan, budget envelope, and risk profile that accompany the funding application.*

### Cross-TIG Strategy at HSB

WEAVE 2027 is hosted by the TIG Entrepreneurship and Innovation, the formal anchor required by the HSB call. The conference invites all nine TIGs on an equal footing in the public call, but internally the Co-Chairs will actively cultivate contributions from the TIGs with the closest substantive connections to Entrepreneurship and Innovation:

- **Sustainable Industry**, industrial innovation, applied research with companies.
- **Digital Transformation**, digital entrepreneurship, technology governance, AI in business.
- **Circular Economy**, green business models, lifecycle thinking in entrepreneurship.
- **Inclusion and Social Justice**, ethics of innovation, equitable transformation.

Cross-TIG breadth in the application should be backed by informal indications of interest from HSB representatives of one or two additional TIGs at the time of submission, ideally captured in a short email exchange. Formal Co-Trägerschaft within HSB is not required by the call and can be settled once funding is granted.

### Partner Outreach Plan

Outreach runs along three parallel channels: the **TIG channel** for breadth, the **bilateral channel** for speed and depth, and the **research center channel** for institutional endorsement and travel funding.

#### TIG channel, primary

- Announcement via the mailing list of the STARS EU TIG Entrepreneurship and Innovation. Reaches E&I members across all nine partner universities at once. Coordinated through the HSB STARS EU office (Katrin Winkler).
- Door-openers via the TIG coordinators of Sustainable Industry, Digital Transformation, Circular Economy, and Inclusion and Social Justice. Allows cross-TIG submissions and signals breadth.
- A short presentation of WEAVE 2027 by the Co-Chairs at the regular meetings of the relevant TIGs, in person or by video. A live appearance turns a mailing-list announcement into a personal invitation and reaches active TIG members directly.
- Announcement on the STARS EU central channels and newsletter.

#### Bilateral channel, complementary

Direct emails from Stephan Form to established personal contacts to accelerate commitments and surface keynote candidates. Stefan Veith in copy. Personal contacts currently identified:

| Partner                                                       | Personal contact                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| IPB Bragança (PT)                                             | Jorge Alvez, Elaine Scalabrini, Paula Fernandez.          |
| Silesian University Opava (CZ)                                | Pavel Adamek. ICFB experience.                            |
| Hanze, Groningen (NL)                                         | Diederich Bakker.                                         |
| Universidad de La Laguna (ES)                                 | Javier Mendoza.                                           |
| UAMD Durrës (AL)                                              | Denada Lica. Visa preparation needed for DE travel.       |
| University West (SE), Cracow (PL), Marie & Louis Pasteur (FR) | No personal contact yet, reached through the TIG channel. |

#### Research center channel, institutional

TIG mailing lists reach scattered individuals. The research centers of the partner universities, by contrast, are living organisational units with a director, internal seminars, a newsletter, and their own mailing lists. When a center director forwards the external two-page CfP, it carries an implicit endorsement worth more than plain advertising. This channel pursues two distinct asks, kept deliberately separate:

- **Dissemination.** The center director forwards the external CfP to suitable colleagues, with a short personal cover note from the Co-Chairs.

- **Travel funding for own researchers.** A center may consider covering the travel and participation costs of its own researchers. This addresses the main participation barrier, travel at the participants' own expense, while no external money enters the WEAVE budget, so no co-branding is owed and the equal footing of the nine TIGs remains untouched. It is the only funding route WEAVE actively encourages.

Outreach states plainly from the outset that WEAVE 2027 publishes no conference proceedings and carries no Scopus or comparable indexing, by design. Centers bound by strict bibliometric funding rules may be unable to sponsor conference attendance on that basis, although ordinary staff travel budgets may still be open. Direct contributions to the WEAVE budget are not solicited: bringing center money in would invite the indexing question in its sharpest form and, through the co-branding it would owe, unsettle the equal footing of the nine TIGs. First outreach runs during the application phase, before the CfP opens on 1 September 2026, and targets centers with a business, management, or entrepreneurship profile.

| Partner                                                    | Lead center for first outreach                               | Status      |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>IPB Bragança (PT)</b>                                   | UNIAG, Applied Research Unit in Management                   | Warm, pilot |
| <b>Hanze, Groningen (NL)</b>                               | Marian van Os Centre of Expertise Entrepreneurship           | First wave  |
| <b>Universidad de La Laguna (ES)</b>                       | IUDE, University Institute of Business                       | First wave  |
| <b>Marie &amp; Louis Pasteur (FR)</b>                      | CRESE, Centre de Recherche sur les Stratégies Économiques    | First wave  |
| <b>Silesian University Opava (CZ)</b>                      | School of Business Administration, Karviná                   | First wave  |
| <b>University West (SE), Cracow (PL), UAMD Durrës (AL)</b> | Research address to be confirmed through the partner contact | Second wave |



## Budget Envelope

Application ceiling per the HSB call of 2026-04-29 is EUR 9 000, split into a EUR 6 000 catering cap and a EUR 3 000 cap for student assistant work and material costs. Additional revenue is generated through **conference fees** charged to participants. Fees absorb any non-funded costs and create headroom for keynote honoraria, online session hosting, or accessibility services if needed.

| Position                                                | Calculation               | Amount           |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------|
| <i>HSB call funding</i>                                 |                           |                  |
| Networking Dinner (Tue evening)                         | 60 TN × 50 EUR            | 3 000 EUR        |
| Catering Conference Day 1 (full)                        | 60 TN × 30 EUR            | 1 800 EUR        |
| Catering Conference Day 2 (half)                        | 60 TN × 20 EUR            | 1 200 EUR        |
| <b>Subtotal catering</b> (cap 6 000 EUR)                |                           | <b>6 000 EUR</b> |
| Student assistant                                       | approx. 100 h × 20.35 EUR | 2 035 EUR        |
| Working materials                                       | lump sum                  | 200 EUR          |
| Conference communication, printed programme             | lump sum                  | 400 EUR          |
| Giveaways with STARS EU branding                        | 60 × 6 EUR                | 360 EUR          |
| <b>Subtotal SHK + Sach</b> (cap 3 000 EUR)              |                           | <b>2 995 EUR</b> |
| <b>HSB call total</b>                                   |                           | <b>8 995 EUR</b> |
| <i>Additional revenue, conference fees</i>              |                           |                  |
| Standard fee, indicative                                | approx. 40 × 180 EUR      | 7 200 EUR        |
| Reduced fee, doctoral, STARS EU and online participants | approx. 20 × 90 EUR       | 1 800 EUR        |
| <b>Conference fee revenue, indicative</b>               |                           | <b>9 000 EUR</b> |

Online participants pay the reduced conference fee. They do not draw on the catering budget, since catering and the networking programme are limited to on-site attendance. The indicative fee figures above will be refined once the on-site and online split is known.

Travel costs for STARS EU partner researchers can be requested separately under the call's individual-case clause, to be coordinated with Katrin Winkler.

## Risks and Mitigations

- **Insufficient partner commitments by deadline.** Work with an indicative list of contacted partners in the application and secure at least four firm commitments by the time the proposal is reviewed.
- **Catering cap exceeded.** Current HSB call budget exactly meets the cap. Any overrun is absorbed by conference-fee revenue or by adjusting the catering scope.
- **Conference website and submission system not yet in place.** Decision needed in summer 2026 on the technical platform, to be confirmed with HSB IT.
- **Competing internal HSB applications.** Strengths to emphasise, cross-TIG breadth, Co-Chair model with established partner contacts, clear publication strategy via Special Issue.

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